Astronomy and Astrophysics: The Spiral of Unconscious Creation

2026-03-23

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Astronomy and Astrophysics: The Spiral of Unconscious Creation

1. Purpose and Question of the Investigation

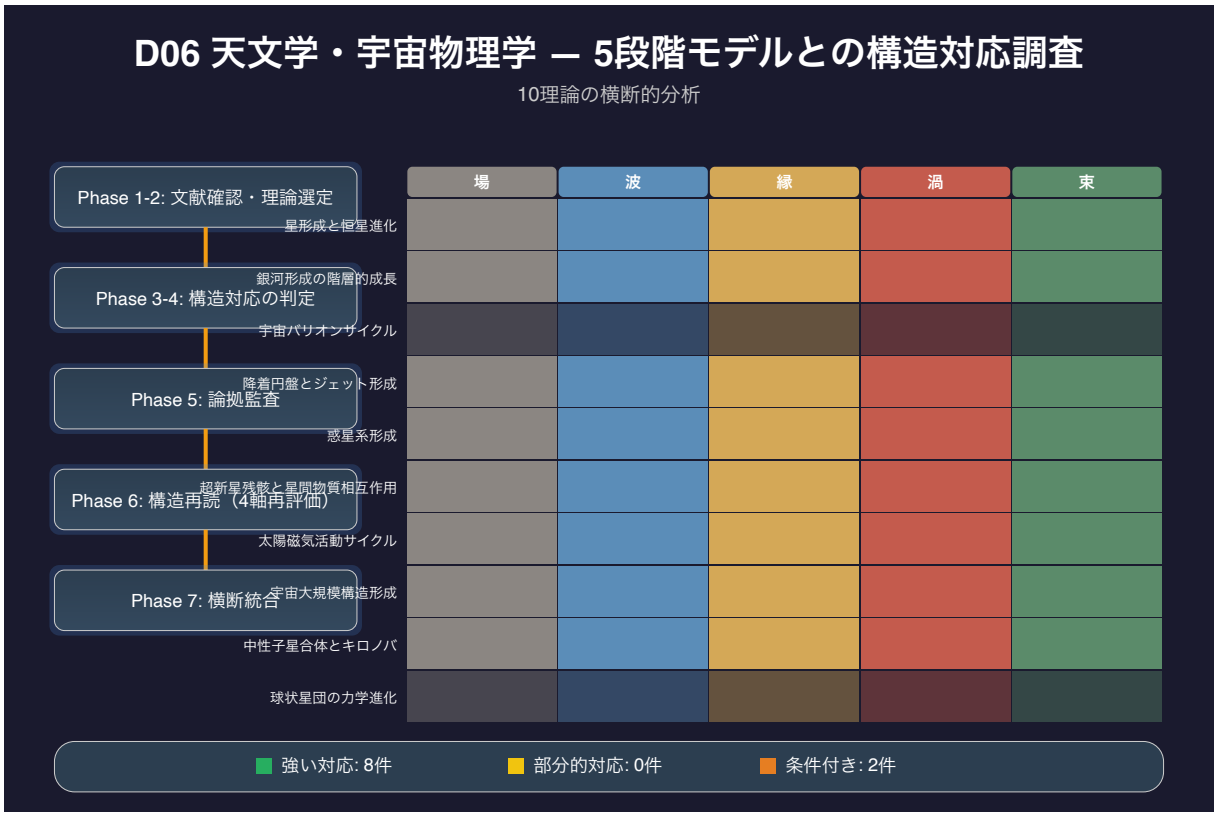

Figure 1: Astronomy and Astrophysics: The Spiral of Unconscious Creation —

This report presents the results of an investigation into whether theories in astronomy and astrophysics correspond structurally to the five-stage model (Field ( ) -> Wave ( ) -> Edge ( ) -> Vortex ( ) -> Bundle ( )).

Astronomy is a discipline that describes processes by which order is generated without the intervention of a conscious subject. From the collapse of molecular clouds to the hierarchical growth of galaxies and the formation of large-scale cosmic structure, interactions among gravity, electromagnetic fields, and nuclear forces spontaneously produce structure. This investigation examines whether such processes correspond to the structure of the five-stage model. It does not use astronomical knowledge to justify any particular theory. This report is an investigation report, not a personal essay or an exposition of the author's ideas.

2. Method of Investigation

Objects of Evaluation

From astronomy and astrophysics, ten theories and phenomena were selected that describe processes in which order spontaneously emerges out of disorder. The selection criterion was that they be established theories supported by observation, simulation, and theoretical calculation.

The cases span the following fields: stellar physics (star formation and stellar evolution, the solar magnetic activity cycle), galactic physics (hierarchical galaxy formation, the cosmic baryon cycle), high-energy astrophysics (accretion disks and jet formation, interactions between supernova remnants and the interstellar medium, neutron-star mergers and kilonovae), planetary science

(planetary-system formation), cosmology (large-scale structure formation), and stellar dynamics (the dynamical evolution of globular clusters).

Evaluation Procedure

For each theory, structural correspondence with the stages of the five-stage model was examined from multiple independent perspectives. In evaluating the stage of Edge in particular, priority was given to its fit with three conditions: relational network (a structure in which multiple physical processes are coupled), indeterminacy (a branching structure in which the outcome remains unsettled for a long period), and vortex connection (a structure in which connection to the next stage can be confirmed).

Criteria of Judgment

"Strong structural correspondence" was assigned when physically clear counterparts could be identified for all five stages and the three conditions of Edge were satisfied. "Partial correspondence" was used when correspondence was present but the description of some conditions was dispersed. "Conditional correspondence" was used when interpreting the correspondence required explicit assumptions.

Limits of the Investigation

This investigation qualitatively examines whether structural correspondences are present; it does not perform tests of statistical significance. Moreover, because astronomy deals exclusively with processes in the absence of a conscious subject, comparison with creative processes involving consciousness lies outside the scope of this investigation. The judgments made here also include cases in which structural similarity and similarity of labels cannot be separated with complete rigor.

3. Overview of the Model

The following explains the stages of the five-stage model referenced in this investigation. It is a model for describing the process by which structure is generated, and it is not limited to any particular scale or domain.

Field - An undifferentiated state. It refers to initial conditions in which neither direction nor structure has yet been determined.

Wave - A stage of exploration in which multiple directions diverge and compete. Differences arise within what had been undifferentiated, and fluctuations appear.

Edge - A state of tension in which opposing elements coexist without converging on either side. This is the core stage of the model and is defined as a structure in which multiple elements are coupled while the outcome remains unsettled.

Vortex - A stage in which a new coherence or order spontaneously arises from within tension. The tension held at Edge is self-organized into a higher-order structure.

Bundle - A stage in which form becomes determinate and stabilizes as a reusable structure. Bundle is not a fixed endpoint; it can become the precondition for a new Field.

If anything in these definitions feels uneasy, that itself is an important perspective for this investigation. Continuing to read while retaining that unease, or leaving the report at this point, are both meaningful choices.

Figure 2: Astronomy and Astrophysics: The Spiral of Unconscious Creation — ×5

4. Findings: Overall Picture

Of the ten theories and phenomena evaluated, all ten showed strong structural correspondence. This makes astronomy one of the domains with the highest rate of correspondence across the full set of thirty domains.

The most distinctive feature of the astronomical domain is its extreme breadth of spatial and temporal scales. The same structural pattern repeatedly appeared across more than twenty orders of magnitude in space and more than fourteen orders of magnitude in time, from nuclear-reaction scales (femtometers, sub-second) to cosmological scales (hundreds of megaparsecs, tens of billions of years). All ten cases realize the five stages without the intervention of a conscious subject, making this the largest-scale domain in which "unconscious structural generation" can be confirmed.

Below, particularly suggestive theories are discussed in detail.

5. Findings: Domain-Specific Insights

5.1 Star Formation and Stellar Evolution: Spiral Nucleosynthesis

The process by which cold molecular clouds undergo gravitational collapse, stars form, and stars evolve is the most basic order-generating process in astronomy. Jeans instability is the mechanism by which, when the mass of a gas cloud exceeds a threshold value (the Jeans mass), the thermal pressure of the gas can no longer resist gravity and collapse begins (Jeans 1902). Crossing this threshold produces the transition from an undifferentiated gas cloud (Field) to amplification of density fluctuations (Wave).

The protostellar disk formed during collapse is a field in which matter inflow and angular-momentum transport interact in complex ways. Gravity, magnetic fields, conservation of angular momentum, and radiative cooling are coupled, and outcomes such as the final stellar mass or the formation of a binary system remain unsettled for a long period. The unstable variability of the T Tauri stage is an observationally confirmed phenomenon of this indeterminate condition. This stage corresponds to Edge.

Nuclear fusion ignited in the stellar core (the pp chain and the CNO cycle) is a self-sustaining structure driven by positive feedback, corresponding to Vortex. The star inscribes a stable pattern in the form of an evolutionary track on the HR diagram (Bundle), and massive stars return heavy elements to the interstellar medium through supernova explosions.

The most important point here is that the return from Bundle to Field is irreversible. The cycle begins with hydrogen gas but returns to a field of gas containing heavy elements. As Carl Sagan put it, "we are made of star stuff"; the return from Bundle to Field does not simply "go back," but generates a more complex Field. This is an important astronomical insight showing that the circulation of the five stages is not a reversible circle but a spiral.

5.2 Accretion Disks and Jets: The Coincidence of Physical and Conceptual Vortex

Accretion disk-jet systems formed around black holes and neutron stars are among the clearest cases in all thirty domains because all five stages can be seen within a single physical system.

MRI (magnetorotational instability) is the mechanism by which a differentially rotating disk with a weak magnetic field is intrinsically unstable and angular momentum is transported outward (Balbus & Hawley 1991). A magnetized, differentially rotating disk provides the initial condition (Field); linear growth of MRI begins (Wave); and energy conversion becomes localized at multiple boundaries such as the ISCO, disk surface, and magnetospheric boundary (Edge). MRI turbulence

drives angular-momentum transport in a self-sustaining way (Vortex), and collimated relativistic jets are formed (Bundle).

This system has two especially striking features. First, the physical "vortex" of MRI turbulence directly coincides with the "Vortex" of the five-stage model. This is rare in other domains. Second, Edge is not singular: multiple boundaries, including the ISCO, disk surface, magnetospheric boundary, and current sheet, are simultaneously established at different scales. This is physical evidence that Edge need not be "a single point of bifurcation" but may instead be a bundled band of relations.

The extraction of energy from rotating black holes through the BZ mechanism (Blandford & Znajek 1977), models of MAD (magnetically arrested disk) accretion (Tchekhovskoy et al. 2011), and the EHT (Event Horizon Telescope) shadow image of M87* (2019) all support this system both theoretically and observationally.

5.3 Planetary-System Formation: The Snow Line as Edge

In the process by which planets form from protoplanetary disks, the snow line, the boundary of water-ice sublimation, provides a particularly clear case of Edge as a physically real entity.

The snow line is the boundary within a disk at which the temperature falls below the sublimation temperature of water ice (Hayashi 1981). Across this boundary, dust composition and particle size change abruptly, and the surface density of solids increases, strongly affecting the efficiency of planet formation. High-resolution ALMA observations, including HL Tau in 2015, confirmed that the snow line is not a "line" but a "band" extending along a temperature gradient.

Streaming instability is the mechanism by which particle concentration grows spontaneously out of the aerodynamic coupling of gas and dust, forming planetesimals (Johansen et al. 2007). This corresponds to the spontaneous self-organization of the Vortex stage.

What is especially interesting in this domain is that two different formation scenarios compete within the same system. The core-accretion model (Pollack et al. 1996) describes formation through gas accretion onto a solid core, whereas the disk gravitational-instability model (Boss 1997) describes direct fragmentation through the disk's self-gravity. The Toomre Q parameter (instability for $Q < 1$) serves as the criterion of discrimination. The fact that different Bundles emerge from the same Field through different passages across Edge is a case that demonstrates the flexibility of the five-stage model.

5.4 Neutron-Star Mergers and Kilonovae: Irreversible Branch Points

GW170817, detected in 2017, was a landmark achievement in multi-messenger astronomy, simultaneously observing gravitational waves, gamma rays, and optical/infrared radiation from a neutron-star merger (Abbott et al. 2017).

A neutron-star binary loses orbital energy through gravitational-wave emission and ultimately merges. This orbital decay (inspiral) is detected as a chirp signal of increasing frequency and amplitude, corresponding to Wave. The instant of merger is an irreversible branch point at which two ultra-dense bodies come into contact, and it corresponds to Edge. General relativity, nuclear forces, neutron degeneracy pressure, and magnetic fields are coupled there, and whether the merger remnant becomes a hypermassive neutron star or collapses directly into a black hole remains indeterminate, depending on the mass ratio and spin.

The neutron-rich matter ejected after merger triggers r-process nucleosynthesis (rapid neutron capture process) (Vortex), and electromagnetic radiation and heavy elements are injected into the interstellar medium as a kilonova (Bundle). The r-process is the principal synthesis pathway for elements heavier than iron, including gold, platinum, and uranium, supplying ultra-heavy

elements that cannot be produced by stellar-core fusion. Subsequent studies have identified individual elements such as strontium (Watson et al. 2019).

This case shows that passage through Edge is strictly irreversible in the sense that once two neutron stars come into contact, they cannot return to separation.

5.5 Dynamical Evolution of Globular Clusters: Solutions Born from Collapse

A globular cluster is a dense stellar system of roughly one hundred thousand to one million stars bound together by self-gravity (Spitzer 1987; Binney & Tremaine 2008). Its dynamical evolution exhibits a distinctive structure in which ordinary thermodynamics is effectively inverted.

Through two-body relaxation, the redistribution of energy by gravitational interactions among stars, fast stars move into the halo region and the core contracts. Because self-gravitating systems have negative specific heat, a core that loses energy becomes hotter and contracts still further, producing positive feedback. This is the gravothermal catastrophe (Lynden-Bell & Wood 1968). In ordinary thermodynamics, losing energy lowers temperature; in self-gravitating systems, the reverse occurs.

As core collapse progresses, binaries formed and hardened in the central region become an energy source. According to Heggie's law (Heggie 1975), hard binaries are hardened further through three-body interactions. These binaries inject energy into the core, halt collapse, and drive core re-expansion (core bounce). Observationally, about twenty percent of globular clusters show post-core-collapse morphologies, M15 being a typical case, providing support for the theory.

No one designed the self-regulating mechanism of binary burning; it emerges spontaneously from the collapse process itself. From the perspective of the five stages, this is a structurally interesting case in which Vortex, the self-regulation of binary burning, is generated immanently out of passage through Edge, the branching toward core collapse.

6. Cross-Cutting Patterns

Universality of Threshold Mechanisms

In at least four of the ten astronomical cases, threshold mechanisms were confirmed as the drivers of the transition from Field to Wave. These include Jeans instability (collapse begins when a gas cloud exceeds the Jeans mass), the Press-Schechter threshold (a halo forms when a density fluctuation exceeds a certain value), Toomre instability (a disk becomes gravitationally unstable for $Q < 1$), and the cold/hot accretion switch (the mode of gas accretion switches at a halo-mass threshold). In every case, the same structural pattern appears: once a small fluctuation exceeds a threshold, a qualitative transition occurs. This threshold structure is also visible in nucleation in chemistry (D03) and the drift barrier in evolutionary biology (D04), and may be a cross-domain pattern common to the Field -> Wave transition of the five stages.

The Band-Like Nature of Edge

In several cases, Edge was confirmed to appear not as a "line" but as a "band." In planetary-system formation, the snow line was directly confirmed by ALMA observations to be a band along a temperature gradient. The circumgalactic medium (CGM) functions as a band tens of kiloparsecs wide lying "between" a galaxy and outer space. Filament-void boundaries in the cosmic web are also boundaries with an extent that can be described only statistically. By contrast, neutron-star mergers are effectively "point-like" branchings. This observation suggests that the width of Edge is distributed on a continuous spectrum ranging from lines to bands.

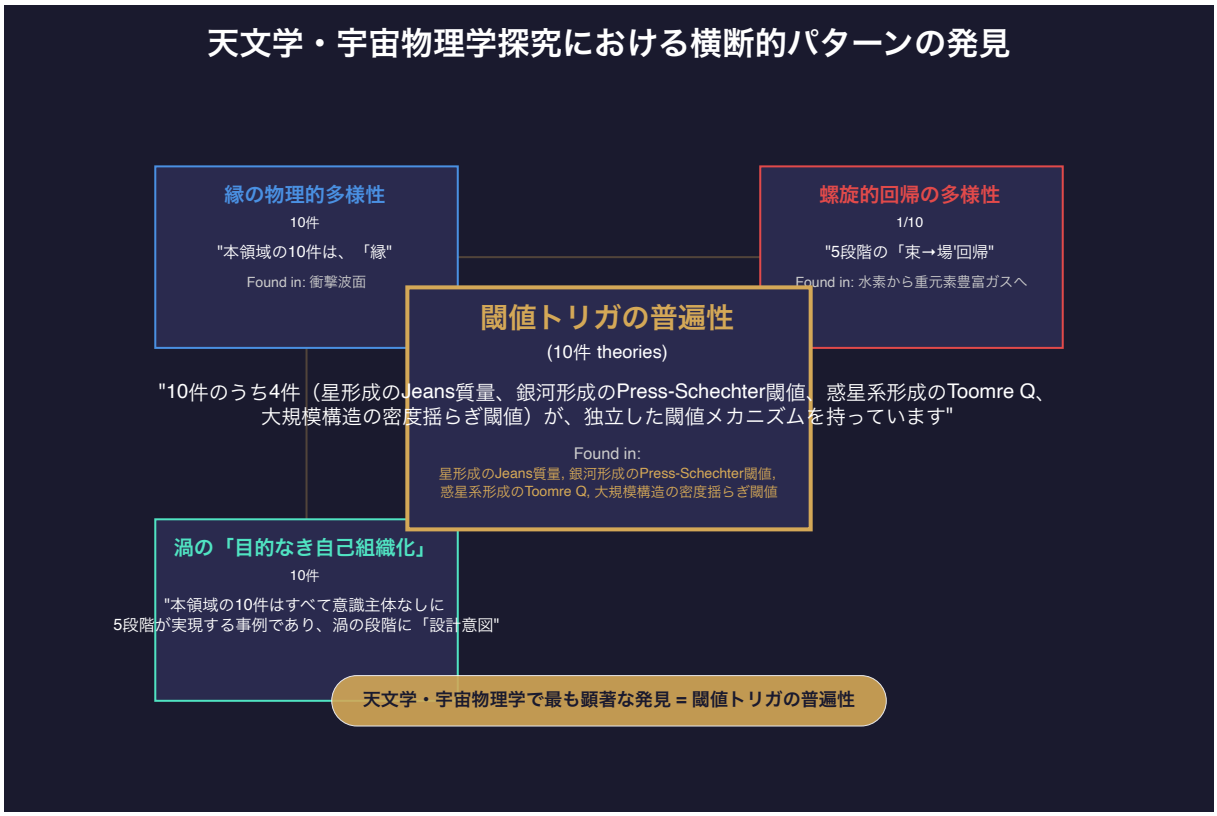

Figure 3: Astronomy and Astrophysics: The Spiral of Unconscious Creation —

The Spiral Character of Bundle -> Field' Return

Element synthesis through stellar evolution (hydrogen -> heavy elements), the chemical evolution of galaxies through the baryon cycle, and the injection of ultra-heavy elements into the interstellar medium through neutron-star mergers all consistently show that the return from Bundle to Field is irreversible, with the material composition of the Field becoming more complex in each cycle. This is consistent astronomical evidence that the "circulation" of the five stages is not a reversible circle but a spiral.

7. Unresolved Questions

Through this investigation, no clear conclusions could be reached on the following questions.

The relation between one-way development and circulation - The evolution of supernova remnants does not circulate; it develops in a one-way sequence. It proceeds from free expansion to the Sedov-Taylor stage, then to the radiative-cooling stage and the dispersal stage, and does not return as an individual SNR. Yet it still contains the five-stage structure. The theoretical status of a "non-circulating five-stage process" remains unsettled.

Negative specific heat and the paradox of Edge - In globular clusters, the intuitive inversion that "temperature rises when energy is lost" may be a general feature associated with passage through Edge, or it may be a property specific to self-gravitating systems. Astronomy alone cannot decide between these interpretations.

Limits of cross-scale comparison - It is a fact that the same structure appeared across a range of more than twenty orders of magnitude in scale. But whether this shows the universality of the structure or merely reflects the observer's tendency toward pattern matching remains open to conflicting interpretations. This question cannot be resolved by astronomy alone and requires

comparison with other domains.

The added value of consciousness - All ten cases realize the five stages without a conscious subject. What, then, is added to the five stages by the presence of consciousness? Astronomy serves as a comparative control group for this question, but the answer itself requires knowledge from other domains that treat consciousness directly.

8. Conclusion

Astronomy and astrophysics are domains in which strong structural correspondence was confirmed in all ten cases. From nuclear-reaction scales to cosmological scales, the structure of the five stages repeatedly appeared in the absence of a conscious subject.

The highest-confidence finding is the irreversible spiral character of Bundle -> Field return. The fact that nucleosynthesis through stellar evolution irreversibly complexifies the material composition of the universe is an established result grounded in stellar physics and nuclear physics.

The diversity and multilayered character of Edge are also strong findings. The diversity of the ten physical realizations of Edge, including physical discontinuity surfaces, temperature boundaries, dynamical bifurcations, and irreversible contact, strongly suggests that Edge is not limited to any single form.

As a more tentative finding, the spontaneous generation of Vortex, the structure by which a solution arises immanently from the process of collapse, as seen in binary burning in globular clusters, remains a question for future investigation as to whether it can be generalized to other contexts.

Astronomy, as a domain that provides the largest-scale demonstration of "unconscious structural generation," offers material for reexamining the scope of the five-stage model. But the confirmation of structural correspondence does not mean that the five-stage model "explains" astronomical processes. It is only a finding that structural similarity is present, and its theoretical implications require careful examination.